Problem-Solution Fit

Phase 3: Project Design Phase

1. Problem Fit

The project addresses the early planning stage of travel, where a user has preferences and constraints but needs help arranging them into a schedule. The strongest fit is not an end-to-end travel marketplace; it is a planning assistant that generates a draft quickly and makes it easier to keep that draft available.

2. Proposed Value

A single form collects the core trip information. The AI service uses these inputs to generate day-wise activities, estimated costs and travel tips. Supabase persistence supports returning to previous plans, and print/save makes the plan portable. Google Maps search links offer a path to external research for hotels and restaurants.

3. Feature-to-Need Relationship

Personalization

The itinerary prompt uses destination, dates, budget, traveller count, interests and travel style. These inputs give the model context for tailoring its response, though they do not guarantee that every recommendation is feasible or accurate.

Continuity

Saved Trips addresses the need to revisit an earlier result. This capability is especially important because a generated plan may be reviewed, shared or modified later.

Place discovery

Hotel and restaurant search links reduce the number of steps required to continue researching options. They are a bridge to an external service rather than a verified place-data integration.

4. Fit Boundaries

The project does not currently handle bookings, payment, real-time hotel availability, confirmed restaurant reservations or guaranteed prices. The model can produce plausible but inaccurate facts, and Google Maps results need independent verification. These boundaries should be clearly stated during a demonstration.

5. Validation Plan

- Ask representative users to plan a realistic trip using the form.
- Observe whether users understand the input fields without assistance.
- Check whether the itinerary structure is easy to review.
- Test whether users can save, reopen and delete a trip.
- Ask users whether the limitations around estimates and map searches are clear.
- Record issues and update the interface based on observed evidence.

6. Conclusion

The current implementation fits a prototype for personalized itinerary drafting. Stronger claims about user satisfaction or time saved require a real evaluation. Future improvements should focus on reliability, factual verification and user testing before adding complex transaction features.